

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **Meta Platforms** agreed to buy six gigawatts' worth of artificial-intelligence computing power from AMD in a deal valued at more than \$100 billion that could result in Meta owning as much as 10% of the chip maker's stock. **A1**
- ◆ **The chip deal** helped fuel a rally in U.S. stocks that lifted both the S&P 500 and Dow industrials by 0.8%, and the Nasdaq by 1%. **B11**
- ◆ **Novo Nordisk** plans to slash U.S. list prices for its popular weight-loss and diabetes drugs Wegovy and Ozempic by up to half starting next year. **B1**
- ◆ **Novo Nordisk** and United Biotechnology said an experimental obesity drug they are jointly developing helped patients lose weight in a mid-stage clinical trial in China. **B2**
- ◆ **U.S. home-price growth** slowed to its lowest annual level in over a decade as mortgage rates and inflation continued to weigh on buyers. **A2**
- ◆ **Warner Bros. Discovery** said it received a revised offer from Paramount to buy the entire company for \$31 a share, up from its previous offer of \$30 a share. **B1**
- ◆ **Spirit Airlines** reached an agreement with its lenders to emerge from bankruptcy by early summer as a smaller company. **B2**
- ◆ **Home Depot** reported lower fiscal fourth-quarter profit as U.S. economic and fiscal headwinds discouraged people from undertaking home improvements. **B3**
- ◆ **BYD** enjoyed a nearly threefold increase in European sales last month as its electric and hybrid vehicles remain in high demand on the continent. **B3**

Worldwide

- ◆ **Trump** touted a "turn-around for the ages" after retaking the White House 13 months ago, seeking in his State of the Union address to convince skeptical Americans that he had unleashed a new era of prosperity. **A1**
- ◆ **The Trump administration** is weighing a possible executive order or other action that would require banks to collect citizenship information from customers. **A2**
- ◆ **Defense Secretary** Pete Hegseth gave Anthropic Chief Executive Dario Amodei until Friday to comply with the Pentagon's demands on using its AI models or face cancellation of the company's contract. **A5**
- ◆ **Bill Gates** apologized to staff of the Gates Foundation over his ties to Epstein, admitting he made mistakes while insisting he didn't participate in Epstein's crimes. **A3**
- ◆ **The House** failed to pass a sweeping air-safety bill, a measure backed by families of victims of a 2025 midair collision, after objections from the Pentagon. **A5**
- ◆ **The family of** Nancy Guthrie offered a \$1 million reward for information leading to her return. **A3**
- ◆ **Tensions** grew between Iranian antiregime activists and pro-government militias as the two sides clashed for a fourth consecutive day. **A6**
- ◆ **The head of the Louvre** stepped down after pressure was applied to the museum's leadership over staff strikes, maintenance problems and security weaknesses. **A7**
- ◆ **Died: Robert Carradine**, 71, film and television actor. **A2**

CONTENTS	
Opinion.....	A13-15
Arts In Review.....	A11
Business & Finance B2-3	Property Report... B6
Business News.....	B6
Sports.....	A12
Crossword.....	A12
Technology.....	B4
Heard on Street.....	B12
U.S. News.....	A2-5
Markets.....	B11
World News.....	A6-7



President Trump addressed Congress on Tuesday in front of Vice President JD Vance and House Speaker Mike Johnson.

Trump Seeks to Quell Anxiety On Economy, Touts Turnaround

Speech aims to sell Americans on an era of prosperity as GOP eyes midterms warily

By ALEX LEARY AND AARON ZITNER

WASHINGTON—President Trump told a national audience on Tuesday that he had unleashed a new age of economic prosperity. One thing he didn't say: I feel your pain.

At the core of Trump's State of the Union address was a calculation that he can persuade the nation that the economy is in better shape than many people think it is.

In touting "a turnaround for the ages," the president opted against sending a message to voters that he understands the anxiety that polling shows is widely felt, including among swing voters the GOP needs to preserve its congressional majorities in this fall's midterm elections.

"Our nation is back, bigger, better, richer and stronger than ever before," Trump declared at the start of his speech, which clocked in at a record one hour and 48 minutes.

Polls find that voters are unhappy with Trump's handling of the economy. In a Wall Street Journal survey last month, voters gave the president low marks when

asked if he cares about "people like you," is looking out for the middle class and has the right priorities.

For months, Trump's top advisers have urged him to focus on the economy, but his attention has often shifted to other subjects, including foreign affairs. As he spoke, Trump was weighing military strikes in Iran.

On Tuesday, Trump made the economy a central focus of his speech, even as he touched on other subjects. He blamed his Democratic predecessor for high inflation and other problems and outlined affordability proposals. He said he would move to impose limits on investors' buying large numbers

of homes and give people without access to a retirement savings plan at work the opportunity to invest in the retirement plan for federal workers. He defended his aggressive use of tariffs, which have strained longtime GOP orthodoxy and given air to Democratic arguments he is driving higher prices on consumers.

In between remarks about the economy, Trump launched pointed attacks against Democrats over immigration and crime, setting off tense exchanges with lawmakers in the House chamber. He emphasized

Please turn to page A4

◆ **Sizing up Trump's economy in year one.....** A4

Meta, AMD Strike Massive Chip Deal

Agreement, aimed at countering Nvidia, is valued at more than \$100 billion

By ROBBIE WHELAN AND MEGHAN BOBROWSKY

Meta Platforms has agreed to buy 6 gigawatts' worth of artificial-intelligence computing power from Advanced Micro Devices in a deal valued at more than \$100 billion that could result in Meta owning as much as 10% of AMD's stock.

The deal, unveiled on Tuesday, represents a coup for AMD in its effort to challenge Nvidia in the market for selling graphics processing units, or GPUs—the microchips powering the AI boom.

Under Tuesday's agreement, Meta will buy enough of AMD's latest chips to power data centers using up to 6 gigawatts of computing power over the next five years. Each gigawatt of computing power means several tens of billions of dollars in revenue for AMD, the company said. Meta is expected to deploy the first gigawatt starting later this year.

As part of the arrangement, AMD agreed to give Meta warrants to buy up to 160 million AMD shares—or about 10% of the company—for a penny apiece, as long as certain milestones are met.

The full stock award is conditional on a rise in AMD's share price. Meta would only receive the final tranche of

Please turn to page A2

◆ **Heard on the Street: Google vs. Nvidia.....** B12

Tech Firms Monitor Workers' Use of Bots

By KATHERINE BINDLEY AND KATHERINE BLUNT

AI use is no longer optional if you work in tech.

While many sectors are still experimenting with artificial intelligence, the tech industry has moved to the next phase: tracking their workers' use of AI tools—and enforcing it if they have to do so.

From small startups to giants including Amazon, Alphabet's Google and Meta Platforms, tech companies are measuring it with an eye on productivity gains and in certain cases factoring it into performance reviews. For

some jobs, candidates aren't even considered unless they can demonstrate AI fluency.

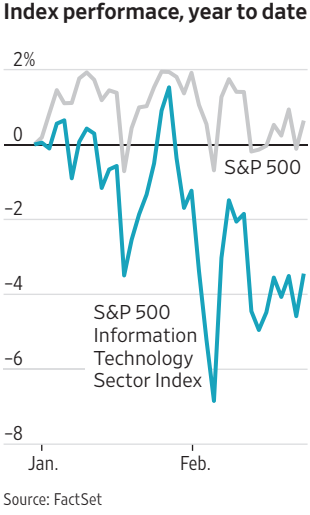
"We are using carrots and sticks," said Seth Besmertnik, chief executive of Conductor, a 300-person digital-marketing startup. "The only way to have a thriving company is if you have all your staff having a high level of competency."

Besmertnik started considering AI use as part of performance reviews at the beginning of this year for his whole company. Employees get an AI

Please turn to page A8

◆ **Breaking down viral post that spooked markets.....** B1

AI-Led Stock Selloff Upends Forecast for Bountiful IPO Year



This was supposed to be a blockbuster year for initial public offerings. Artificial-intelligence fears spoiled the party.

Investors have been thirsting for new issues, and big names including SpaceX, OpenAI and Anthropic are still readying debuts for later this year. The momentum created an opening for dozens of smaller, mainly private-equity backed software firms that had been waiting in the wings.

Then fears that AI will upend the software industry

sent stocks tumbling this month. The selloff accelerated Monday after a viral blog post about the threat posed by AI.

Bankers and investors now expect the few megaofferings to dominate the year. Most private tech companies—many that have spent years bidding their time—will be forced to keep waiting it out. The U.S. IPO market, dormant for years, finally started to look up for tech companies last year. Among the early casualties are Blackstone-

Please turn to page A5

◆ **Heard on the Street: AI can be boom or bust.....** B12

Congee, Tai Chi and Chinamaxxing

Americans are going all in on the Chinese lifestyle

By HANNAH MIAO

Noë Bryant spent 41 years identifying as African American. This year, she became Chinese.

Inspired by viral videos on social media, Bryant dragged her husband and two children to their local Asian grocery store in Austin, Texas. She asked ChatGPT which Chinese pantry staples she should buy and spent around \$200 stocking up on soy sauce, goji berries and other ingredients.

"I told ChatGPT, 'I want to become a Chinese baddie,'" said Bryant, a stay-at-home mom.

Please turn to page A10

Maduro Is Gone, But Regime Remains

The U.S. expects Venezuela's leaders to attract investors by fixing all they broke

By PAUL KIERNAN

Dozens of armed government agents swarmed the offices of shrimp producer Grupo Lamar, a family owned business that had emerged as one of Venezuela's largest exporters after the collapse of the oil industry.

The owners are terrorists, agents told petrified workers. You now work for the Venezuelan state, the agents said, according to people familiar with what happened.

In a news conference about the seizure, Diosdado Cabello, Venezuela's interior minister, said Grupo Lamar's owners had been plotting to overthrow the government, sabotage the electrical grid—and even ruin the holiday

season.

"It's the same playbook as always—trying to cancel Christmas in Venezuela," said Cabello, who is responsible for quashing dissent against the regime.

Venezuelan officials fired top managers at Grupo Lamar and took control of operations. Before long, shrimp exports were falling even faster than oil output had dropped years earlier. No one was surprised.

The regime has been seizing companies and running them into the ground for more than two decades, turning what was once Latin America's most affluent country into one of its poorest.

Please turn to page A8

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